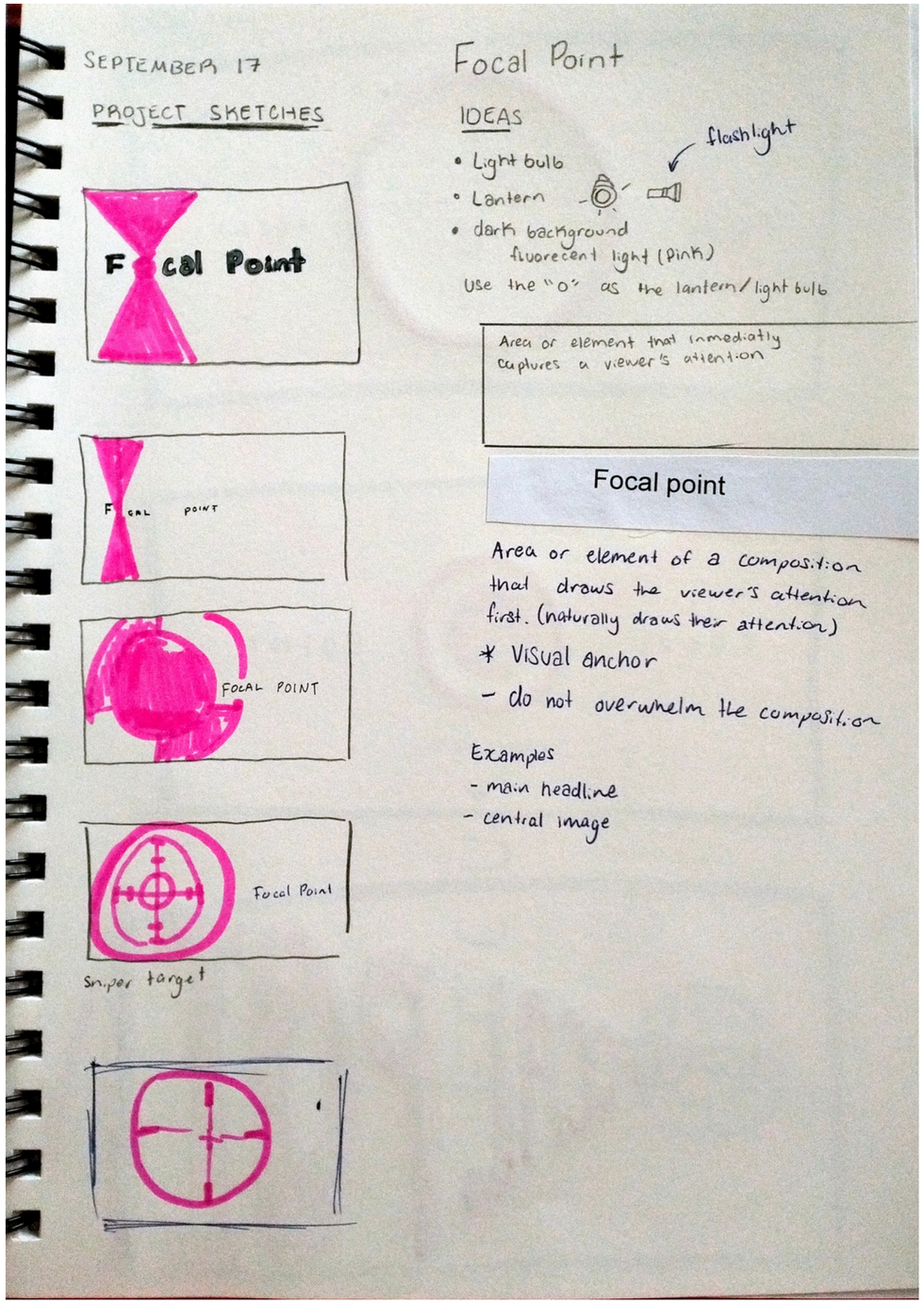


Design Vocabulary Poster



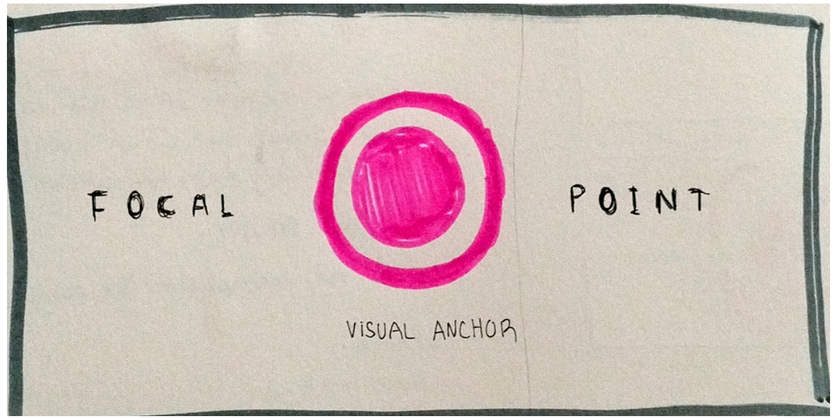
Context of the Project

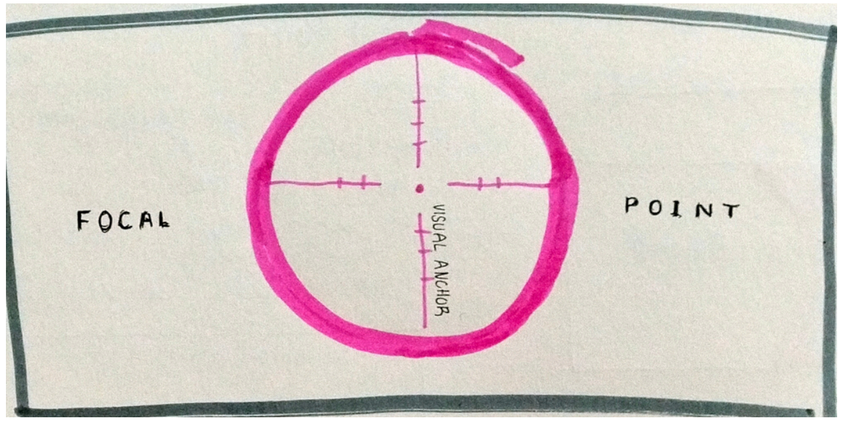
The goal for this individual project was to design a poster that illustrated a specific design principle through the combined use of visual language and text, allowing the viewer to understand the principle both visually and conceptually. The principle I focused on was focal point, defined as an area or element within a composition that naturally draws the viewer's attention.

One of the limitations for this project was the inability to choose any design style, as all decisions needed to align with the assigned principle. Since the concept of a focal point relied on a single dominant element, the design could not include excessive ornamentation or decorative details that could distract from the central element. Additionally, I had no prior experience with Rizzo printing, which in this case was limited to the use of four colors. This constraint required me to carefully consider how to implement the color palette in a creative and effective way.

Process and Sketches

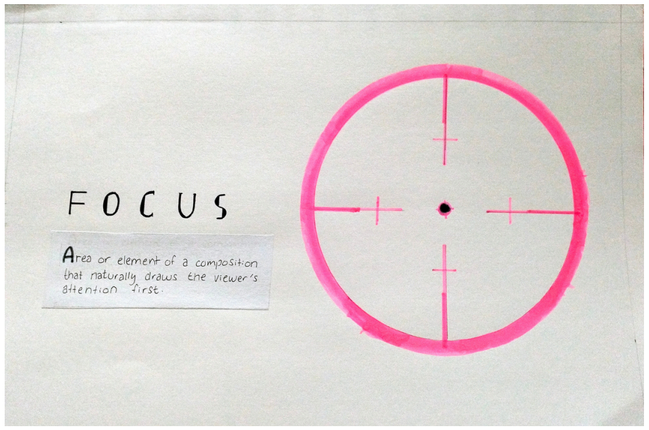
The initial ideas for this project all focused on featuring a single object that would occupy most of the poster's space establishing it as the focal point of the horizontal composition. Two of the selected concepts were further developed: one of a flashlight, from which the words "focal point" would gradually increase in size (shown in the bottom right image), and another based on a sniper's scope (shown in the middle image).

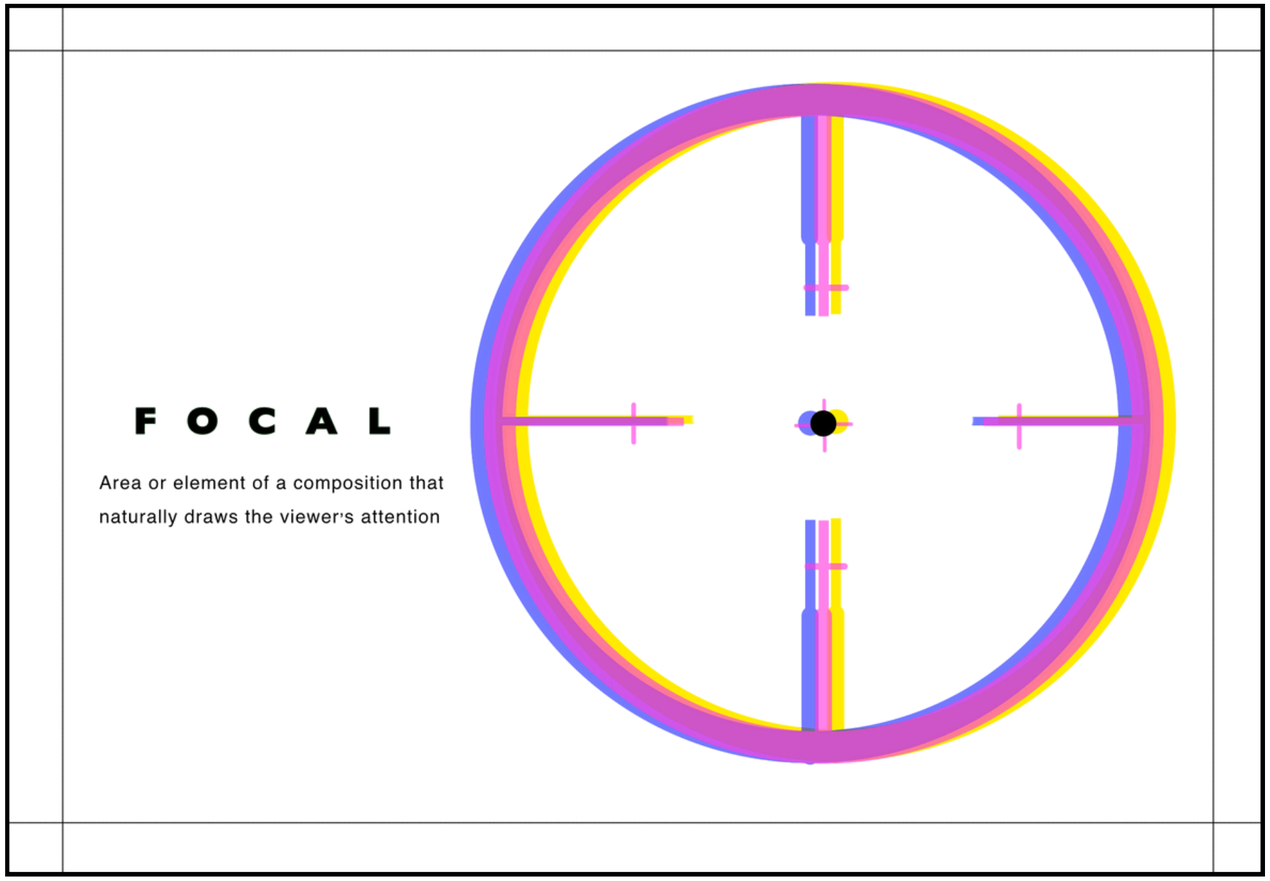












Process and Sketches

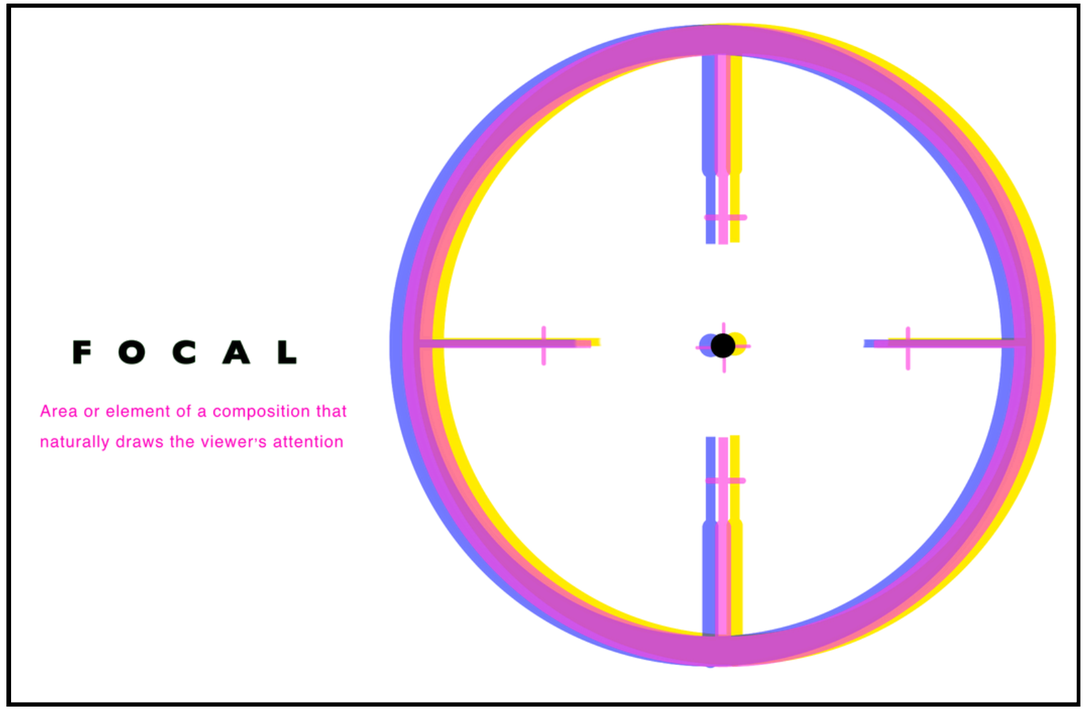
After sketching my ideas in my notebook and choosing the sniper's scope as the final concept, I used Ibis Paint X to digitally illustrate how I envisioned the final work to look like. This process allowed me to experiment with layer transparency and achieve a distorted effect around the circular form of the scope.

After exploring several variations and implementing the feedback from professor Erin, I decided to use the central point of the scope as visual language for the word "point" rather than representing it literally. This approach created a fun and clever way of suggesting its meaning. Using this medium also allowed me to test out different typefaces and fonts so that they would align the size and thickness of the dot, making it appear as a continuation of the word and unifying both elements clearly.

Approach and Final Sketch

From the beginning, my approach focused on meeting the project's goal by prioritizing simplicity and visual communication over complexity. As an artist, I am often tempted to incorporate detailed textures and multiple elements into my work; however, this project challenged me to embrace simplicity and restraint.

Throughout the process, I continuously questioned each design decision by asking myself whether an added element was truly necessary and whether it strengthened the visual meaning of the focal point or introduced unnecessary noise. I also considered how other design principles could be applied without competing with or confusing the central concept.





Reflection

While there are aspects I would have liked to change, particularly the transparency of the circular forms used for the Rizzo print, as well as the decision to display the meaning of the principle in pink rather than black, which caused it to blend into the background, I was overall satisfied with the final outcome. The poster achieved a clean, direct, and visually clear result that effectively communicated the principle. Most importantly, the work felt original and personal, as it was entirely developed from my own ideas.

Through this project, I learned how to Rizzo print, a process I had never explored before, and gained a deeper understanding of discipline and critical reflection in design. I developed greater awareness of how to apply design principles intentionally without overcrowding the composition or drifting away from the core concept.